

NOVAHR

HR and Payroll, Built for South African Business

SARS Compliance Calendar 2026/27

Key payroll submission dates for South African employers

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Monthly (every month)

Deadline	Obligation	Detail
7th	EMP201 return and payment	PAYE + UIF + SDL for the previous month, via eFiling/EFT. Late payment: 10% penalty plus interest, automatic
7th	UIF payment	Included in EMP201 if SARS-registered; otherwise direct to the UIF
Month-end	UI-19 declaration	Employee and contribution declarations to the Department of Employment and Labour (uFiling), including new starters and terminations

Annual and Bi-Annual

Period	Obligation	Detail
March	New tax year begins (1 March)	New SARS tables apply from the first March payroll. NovaHR ships the update; verify your first March run
April/May	EMP501 annual reconciliation	Reconcile 12 months of EMP201s against payroll; SARS opens the window by notice (historically 1 April to 31 May)
After annual EMP501	IRP5/IT3(a) certificates	Issue to all employees for their income tax returns
September/October	EMP501 interim reconciliation	Covers March to August; window per annual SARS notice
April-June	Workplace Skills Plan / Annual Training Report	To your SETA (30 April deadline typically) to claim SDL mandatory grants back
Annually	Return of Earnings (ROE / W.As.8)	COIDA return to the Compensation Fund; window announced yearly (typically opens 1 April)
Employment Equity reporting	1 September to 15 January (online)	Designated employers only (50+ employees or sector turnover thresholds)

Event-Driven

Event	Obligation
New employee	Capture tax number; declare on next UI-19; register for PAYE if first employee
Termination	UI-19 update (enables UIF benefit claims); final payslip must include accrued leave payout
Crossing R500,000 annual payroll	Register for SDL
Salary threshold changes gazetted	Re-check BCEA earnings threshold impact on overtime rights

Penalties for Missing Deadlines

- EMP201 late: 10% of the amount, automatic, plus interest;
- EMP501 late or incorrect: administrative penalties per certificate;
- UI-19 failures: employees cannot claim benefits, and non-compliance is an offence;
- ROE late: penalties and inability to obtain a Letter of Good Standing (needed for many contracts).

How NovaHR Helps

- Payroll reports give you the exact EMP201 figures each month;
- Employee records hold the tax numbers you need at reconciliation time;
- Terminations are recorded with dates for UI-19 updates;
- Every March update is announced in release notes.

NovaHR does not file on your behalf. Diarise the 7th of every month now.